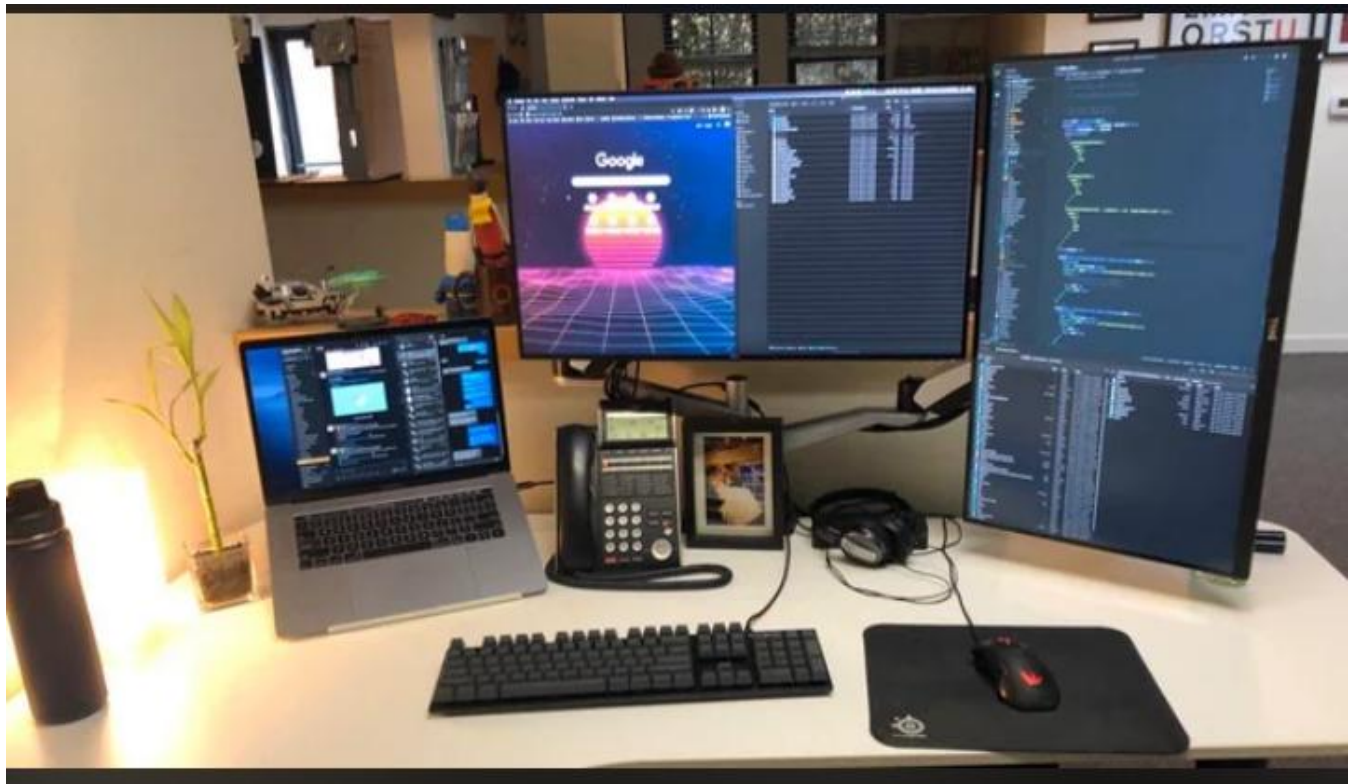
COLLEGE DE PARIS SUPERIEUR

Session 1: The IT Professional's Toolkit

Bachelor 3 – IT English Mastery



Dorcas Tchogoue

"The bridge"

Meet Kate …








NO


REJECTED





1. "Your **README** says '**run the script**.' Which interpreter? What dependencies?"
2. "Your **error log** mentions '**null pointer**' but gives no context.
   How do we reproduce it?"
3. "You call this tool '**fast**.' By what metric? Compared to what?"

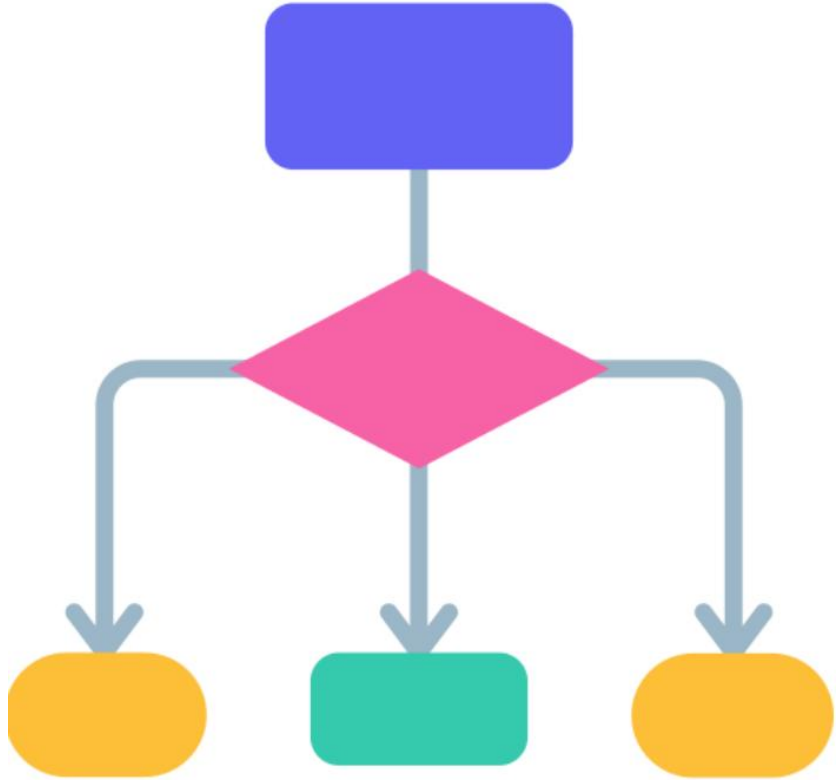


Communicating Clearly in the Tech World

- From Docs to Demos



Roadmap & Objectives



Today You Will:

1. **Decode** advanced IT vocabulary in context.
2. **Navigate** a piece of technical documentation.
3. **Draft** a professional email.

Activity: Quick poll

"How often do you read technical content in English?"

(Daily / Weekly / Rarely / Never)



The Alphabet Soup: IT Acronyms



The Acronym Challenge!
5 min

Write down as many IT acronyms as you know and what they stand for.

Examples:

API (Application Programming Interface)

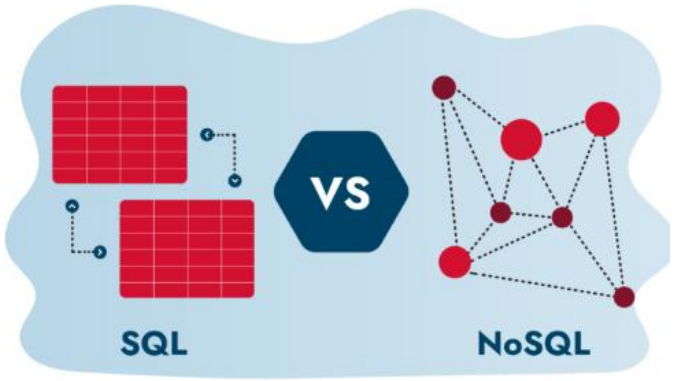
SSH (Secure Shell)

UI (User Interface)

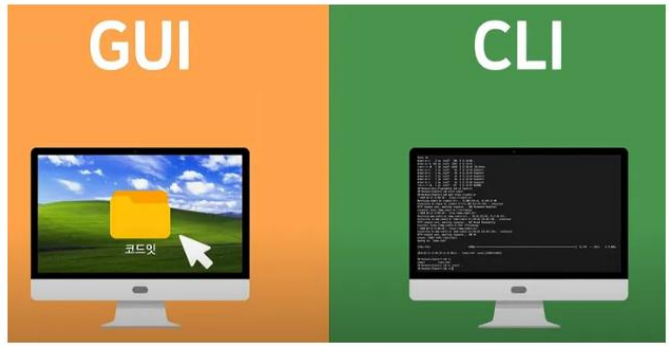


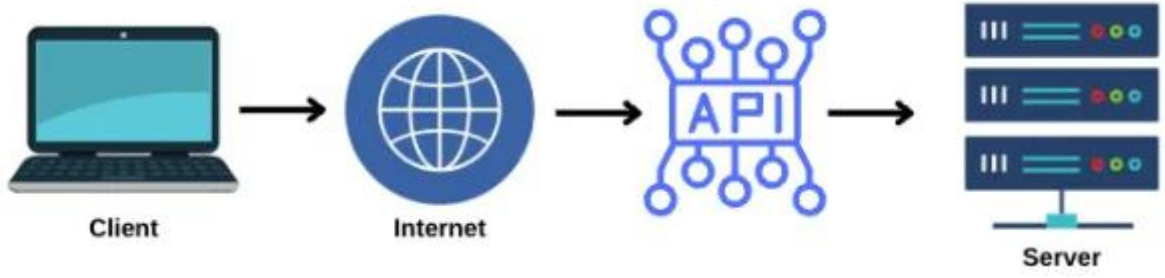
Acronyms

DevOps	Software development (Dev) and IT operations (Ops)
CI/CD	Continuous Integration/Continuous Delivery or Deployment
API	Application Programming Interface
SQL/NoSQL	Structured Query Language/Not Only SQL
HTTP/S	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure
SSH	Secure Shell
GUI/CLI	Graphical User Interface/Command-Line Interface









IT Acronyms

- DevOps
- CI
- CD
- UI
- API
- SQL
- NoSQL
- HTTP/S
- SSH
- GUI
- CLI



Module 1: Why Vocabulary is Your API Key

- Precision => Professionalism
- The 3 Vocab Types: Technical, Acronyms, Jargon/Slang



Vocabulary Deep Dive - Context is King

One Word, Many Tech Meanings: "**DEPLOY**"

"We will deploy the update on Tuesday." (To release/roll out software)

"The team deployed to the data center." (To move/position people)

"Deploy the backup generator." (To bring into operation)



Soldiers are deploying

Vocabulary Exercise - The Correct Term



Exercise: Choose the correct, more precise term.

1."The system is really slow." vs. "The system is experiencing high latency / slowness."

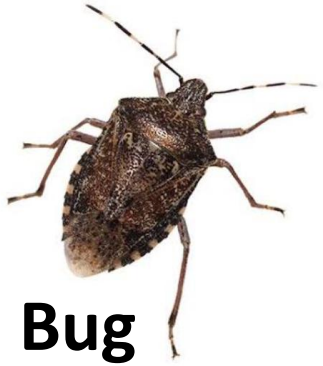
2."The website is broken." vs. "The service is down / not working."

3."We fixed the bad thing in the code." vs. "We patched the vulnerability / problem."

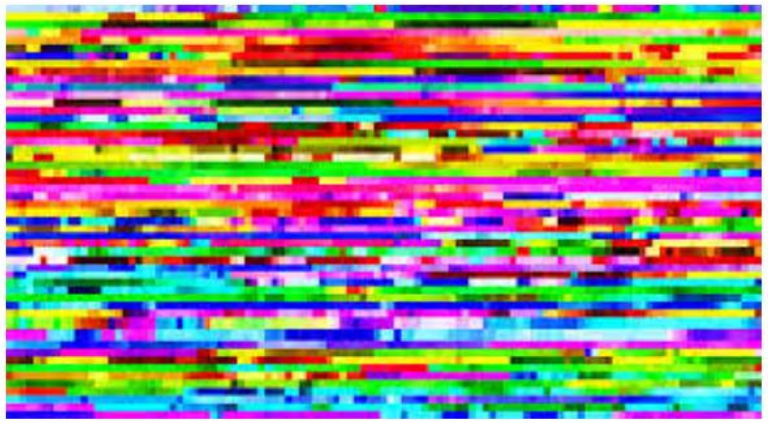
Brainstorm:

What's the difference between:
- a bug,
- a glitch,
- a vulnerability, and
- an exploit?





Bug



Glitch

- **Bug**: A flaw or defect in software or hardware that causes unexpected results.
- **Glitch**: A sudden, usually temporary malfunction of equipment
- **Vulnerability**: A weakness that could be exploited.
- **Exploit**: a software tool designed to take advantage of a flaw in a computer system (like gaining unauthorized access or installing malware).

Tech Vocab Deep Dive:
Networks & Cloud

Latency vs. Bandwidth



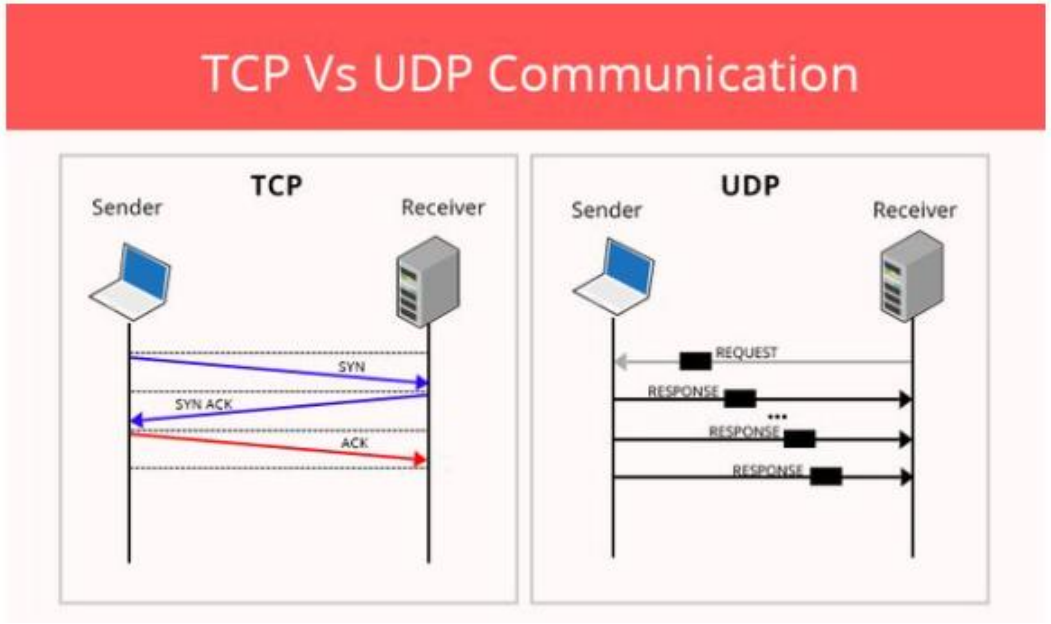


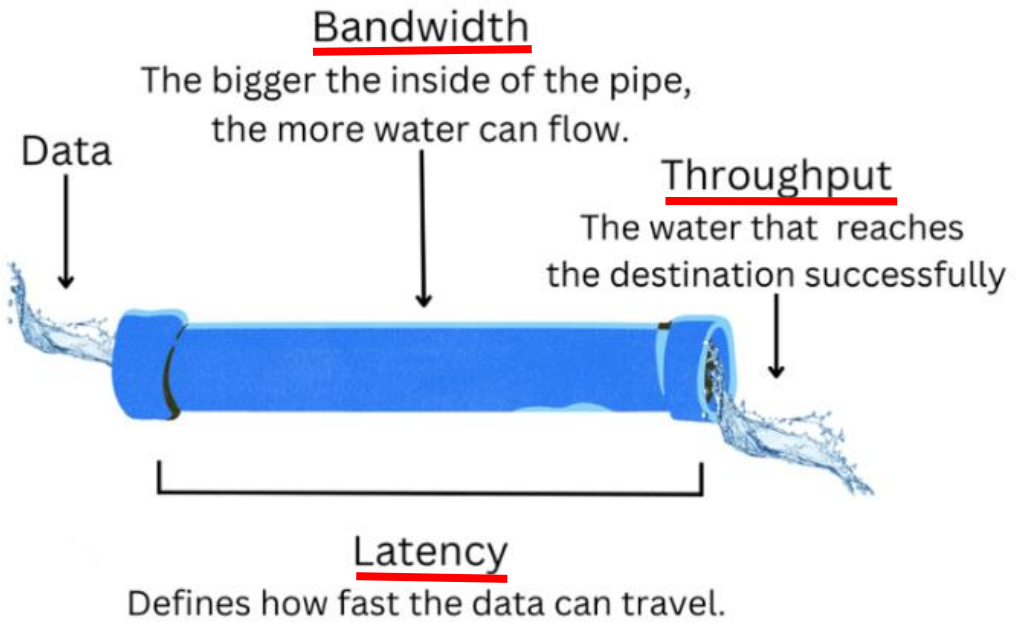
NETWORKS





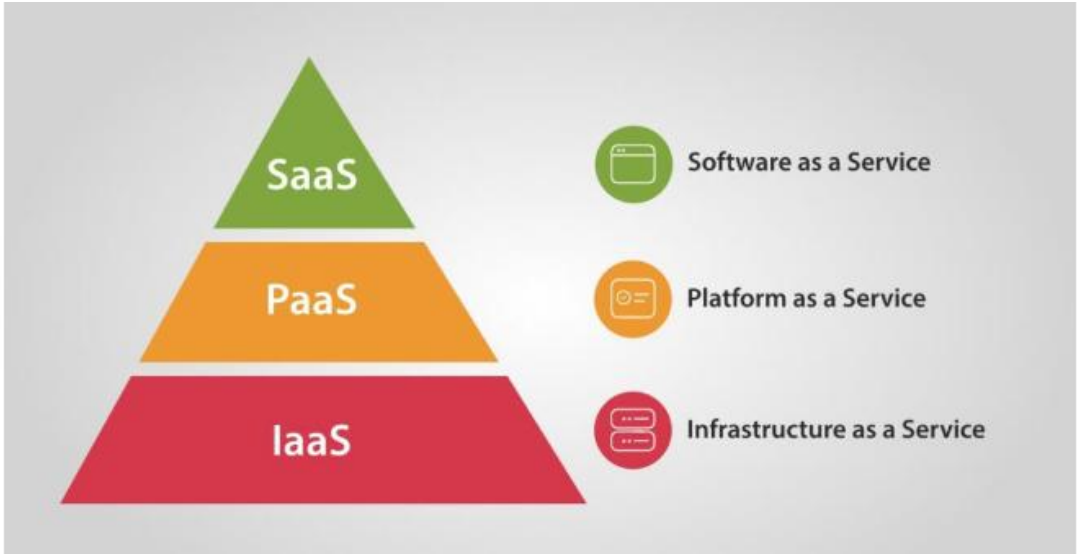
Switch VS Router

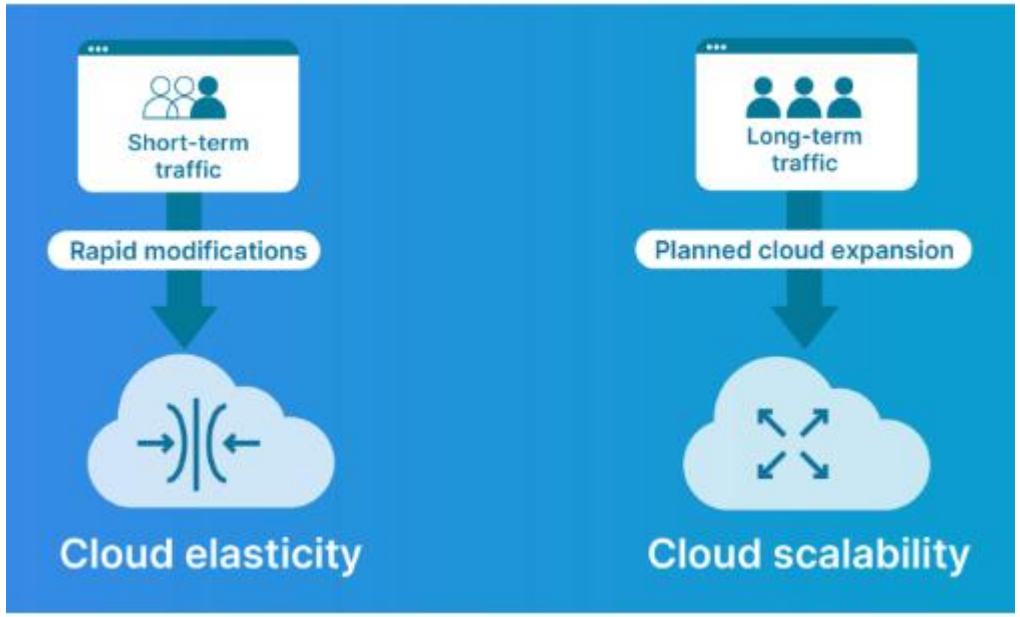


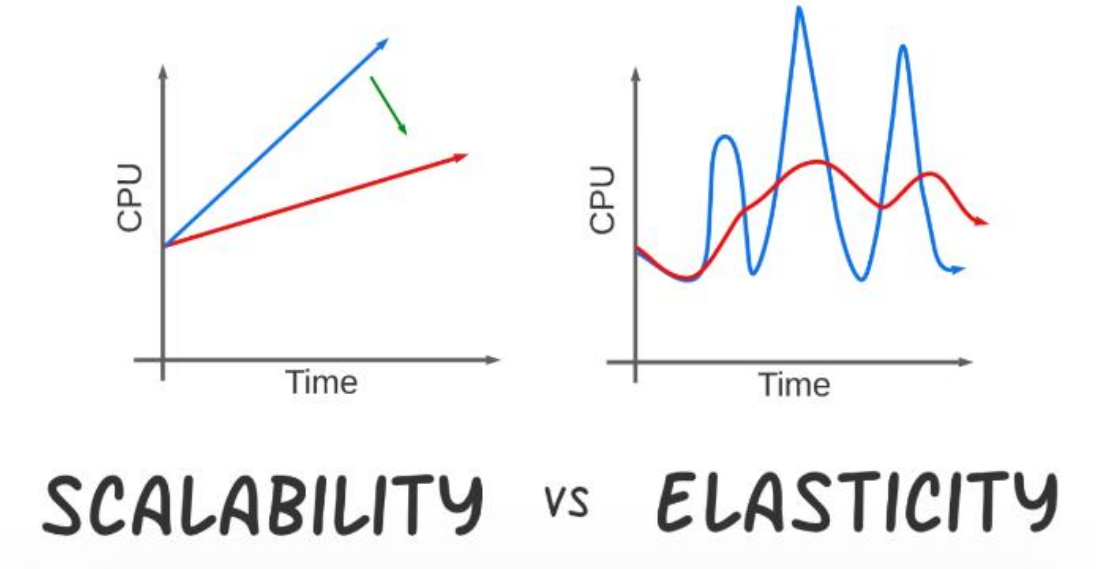


Networks	
Latency	(Delay):The time it takes for a single data packet to travel from source to destination (e.g., milliseconds).
Bandwidth	(Capacity): The maximum amount of data that can be transferred per second (e.g., Mbps, Gbps)
Throughput	(Actual Rate): The actual, measured amount of data successfully transferred per unit of time (e.g., MBps,.
Switch	A switch connects multiple devices to create a network
Router	A router connects multiple switches, and their respective networks, to form an even larger network.
TCP	(Transmission Control Protocol): Reliable, slower, used for text communication
UDP	(User Datagram Protocol): Fast, unreliable, prioritizes speed over accuracy, used for online gaming, media streaming.

CLOUD


SaaS
PaaS
IaaS
Software as a Service
Platform as a Service
Infrastructure as a Service


Short-term traffic
Rapid modifications
Long-term traffic
Planned cloud expansion
Cloud elasticity
Cloud scalability


CPU
Time
CPU
Time
SCALABILITY
VS
ELASTICITY

Cloud	
IaaS	(infrastructure as a service): offers raw computing resources (VMs, storage) for maximum control (like renting land)
PaaS	(platform as a service): provides a development environment with tools (like renting a furnished workshop)
SaaS	(software as a service): delivers ready-to-use applications (like a finished product you just use)
Scalability	Scalability is your long-term strategy, ensuring your tech grows with your business.
Elasticity	Elasticity is your short-term solution for handling unexpected changes ...

Activity: Concept Check:

"If Netflix buffers, is it a latency or bandwidth issue?" (Discuss).



Tech Vocab Deep Dive:
Cybersecurity & AI







Phishing

Encription

AI

Cybersecurity

Phishing	Phishing is a cyberattack using fake messages (email, text, calls) from seemingly trusted sources (banks, companies) to trick people into revealing sensitive info (passwords, bank details)
Malware	Malware (malicious software) is harmful code designed to disrupt, damage, or gain unauthorized access to computer systems, networks, and data, often for financial gain or data theft, including types like viruses, ransomware, spyware, and worms that steal info or hold systems hostage.
Ransomware	Ransomware is a type of malicious software—or malware—that prevents you from accessing your computer files, systems, or networks and demands you pay a ransom for their return.
Encryption	Encryption is when we change normal text into secret code. Only someone with the key can open it back.



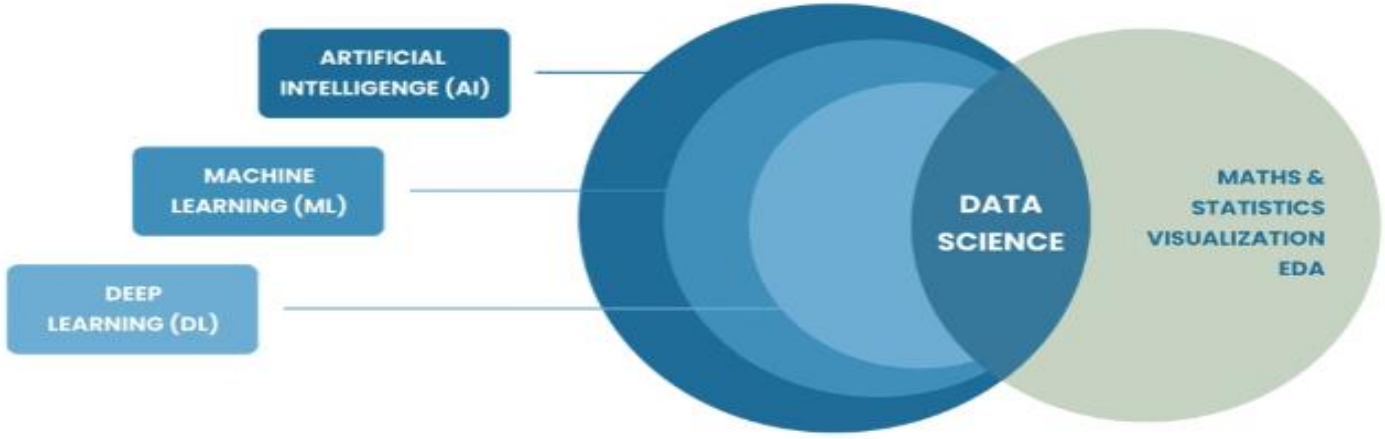


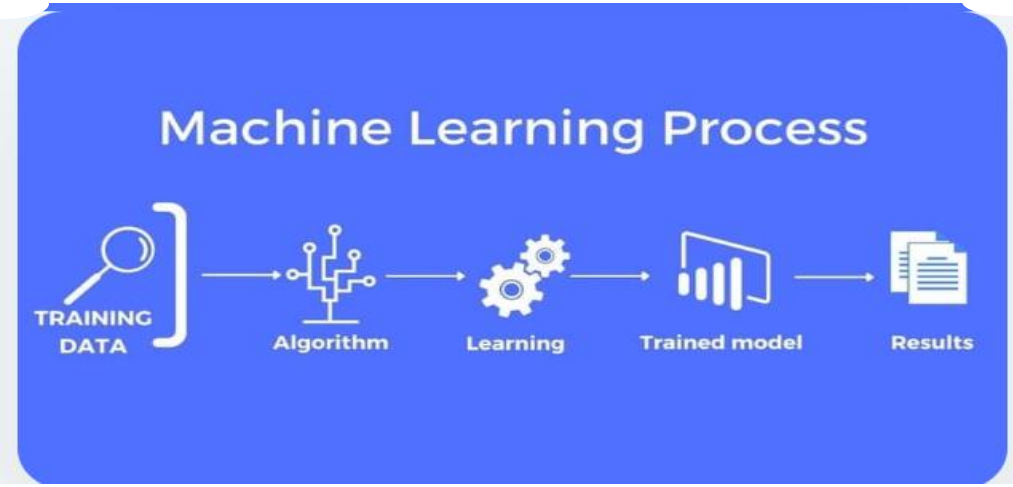




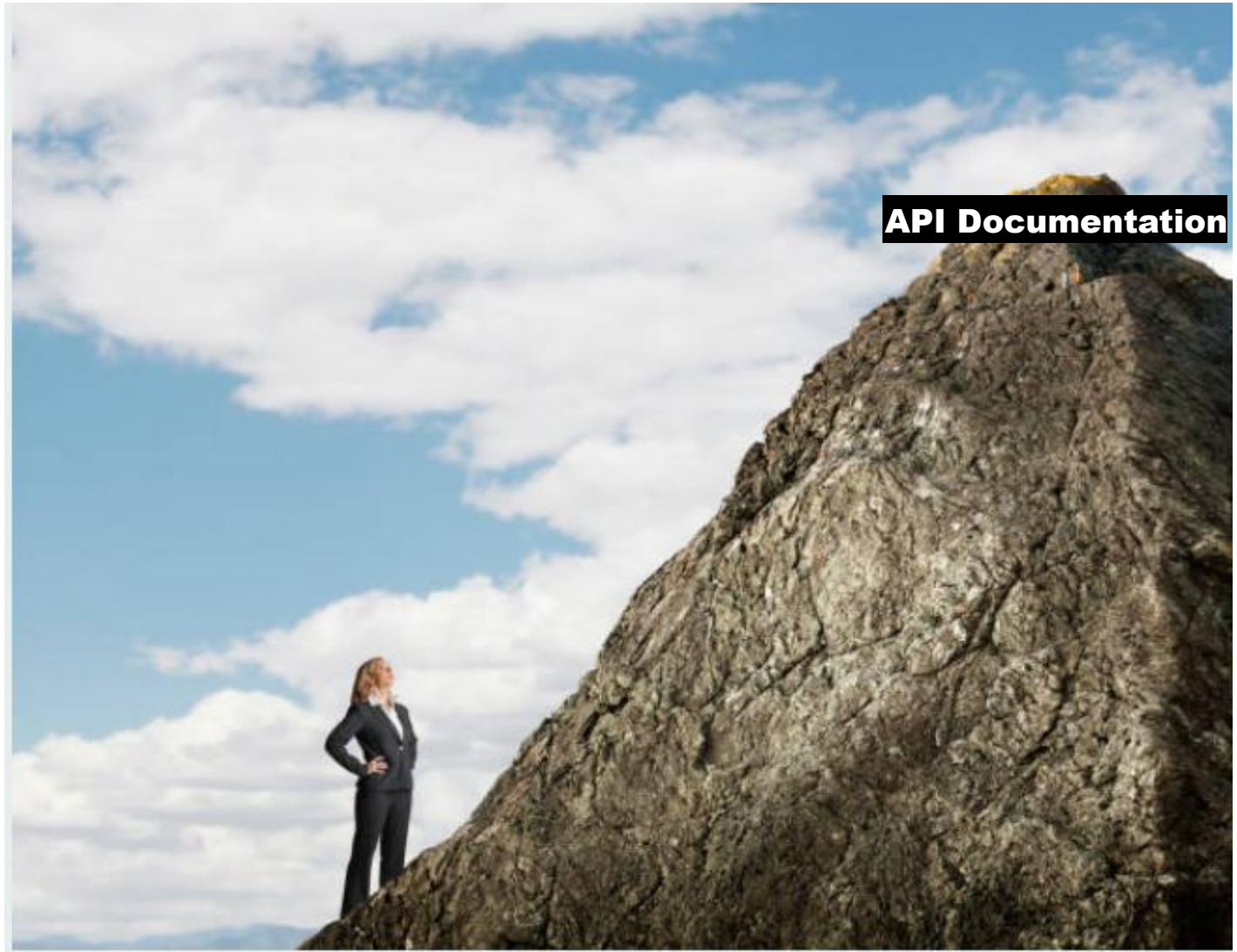
Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning (AI/ML)

Algorithm	A set of rules or instructions the computer follows to solve a problem or perform a task.
Training Data	The input information (e.g., images, text, historical records) used to "teach" the algorithm.
Model	The output of the training process.
Prediction	The output or decision generated by the trained model when given new input data.
Bias	Bias in machine learning is a systematic error that skews predictions or decisions made by a model.





Module 2:
Conquering Technical Documentation



Anatomy of an API Doc (e.g., Stripe, Twilio)

API Documentation Essentials

1. Core Components

Endpoints: Specific URL paths for resources

(e.g., /api/users)

Methods (HTTP Verbs):

GET → Retrieve data

POST → Submit/create data

PUT/PATCH → Update data

DELETE → Remove data

2. Request & Response

Parameters: Path: /users/{id}

Query: ?search=john&limit=10

Body: JSON data (for POST/PUT)

Status Codes:

200 OK → Success

201 Created → Resource made

400 Bad Request → Client error

404 Not Found → Resource missing

500 Server Error → Backend problem

3. Key Action Verbs

Verb	HTTP Method	Purpose
retrieve	GET	Fetch existing data
submit	POST	Send new data
update	PUT/PATC	Modify existing data
delete	DELETE	Remove data

Quick Example:

text

GET /api/products/123
→ Retrieve product #123 details

POST /api/orders
→ Submit a new order

Response: 201 Created

```
{
  "order_id": 789,
  "status": "processing"
}
```

In-Class Activity: API Detective

The Mission

Decode this real-world API scenario.



Scenario:

A weather app needs to:

- Get today's forecast for Paris
- Report a faulty weather station
- Update a user's preferred cities list

Your Task

For each action below, choose the correct:

HTTP Method (GET, POST, PUT/PATCH, DELETE)

Endpoint (from options)

Likely Status Code for success

Action	HTTP Method	Endpoint	Success code
1. Fetch Paris forecast	?	/api/forecast/today	?
2. Report broken station	?	/api/issues/report	?
3. Update user's cities	?	/api/user/preferences	?

Endpoint Options:

/api/forecast/today
/api/issues/report
/api/user/preferences
/api/stations/delete

Status Code Options:

200 OK
201 Created
204 No Content

Your Task

For each action below, choose the correct:

HTTP Method (GET, POST, PUT/PATCH, DELETE)

Endpoint (from options)

Likely Status Code for success

Action	HTTP Method	Endpoint	Success code
1. Fetch Paris forecast	**GET**	/api/forecast/today	**200 OK**
2. Report broken station	**POST**	/api/issues/report	**201 Created**
3. Update user's cities	**PUT/PATCH**	/api/user/preferences	**200 OK**

Answer Key:

GET, /api/forecast/today, 200 OK
POST, /api/issues/report, 201 Created (new issue ticket)
PUT/PATCH, /api/user/preferences, 200 OK

Reading Tech Docs - Anatomy of a README.md

Don't Read Everything. Find What You Need.



1. **Title** – What is this project?
2. **Requirements** – What do I need to install first?
3. **Installation** – What command do I run?
4. **Usage** – How do I run it?
5. **Troubleshooting** (**Help**)- "What do I do if it doesn’t work?

Activity: 60-Second Scan Challenge - Group Work

TextCleaner CLI

A simple command-line tool to clean and format text files. Remove extra spaces, fix line endings, and sort lines alphabetically.

📋 **Requirements**

Python 3.8 or higher

Pip package manager

⚙ Installation

1. Clone the repository:

```
bash
git clone https://github.com/example/textcleaner.git
```

2. Navigate to the folder:

```
bash
cd textcleaner
```

3. Install dependencies:

```
bash
pip install -r requirements.txt
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

🚀Basic Usage

Clean a text file:

```
bash
python textcleaner.py --file my_document.txt
```

Sort lines in a file:

```
bash
python textcleaner.py --file my_document.txt --sort
```

1. What is the main purpose of this tool?

2. What is one prerequisite?

3. What is the first installation command?

4. What command would you run to sort lines in "notes.txt"?

🆘 Troubleshooting

Error: "Python not found"

- Make sure Python 3.8+ is installed. Check with python --version.

Error: "No such file or directory"

- Check that you're in the correct folder and the file exists.

Permission denied

- Try running the command with administrator rights.

Activity Questions & Answers

What is the main purpose of this tool?

Answer: To clean and format text files (remove spaces, fix line endings, sort lines).

What is one prerequisite?

Answer: Python 3.8 or higher (or Pip package manager).

What is the first installation command?

Answer: git clone https://github.com/example/textcleaner.git

What command would you run to sort lines in "notes.txt"?

Answer: python textcleaner.py --file notes.txt --sort

Writing Professionally - The Email (Part 1: Structure)

The Professional IT Email: Clear, Concise, Action-Oriented.
The A-B-C Structure

A - Actionable Subject Line: Tell them what and why before they open.
eg.: => "Urgent: VPN Access Issue for User jdoe - Ticket #67"

B - Body (BLUF - Bottom Line Up Front): State the most important information in the first 1-2 sentences.

❌ **Bad**: "Hope you're well. I was working on the server thing, and I noticed something might be wrong, so I wanted to ask you about..."

✅ **Good**: "This email is to request your approval for the server migration scheduled for Friday night. The backup has been verified, and the downtime is estimated at 2 hours."

C - Clear Call to Action (CTA): "Please review the logs by EOD and confirm."

❌ **Bad**: "Let me know what you think."

✅ **Good**: "Please approve the attached plan by EOD Tuesday."

✅ **Good**: "Could you review the logs and confirm the root cause by 4 PM?"

Bad Email vs. Good Email

✗ Confusing Email	✓ A-B-C Professional Email
Subject: Help! **Body:** Hi, I'm having trouble with the database. It's not working right and the team is asking me. Can you take a look when you have time? Thanks.	**Subject:** Action Required: Database Connection Timeout Error - App 'Payments' **Body:** We are experiencing critical database timeouts for the Payments application since 10:00 AM. This is causing transaction failures. I have attached the error logs. Please investigate and provide a status update by 12:00 PM.

Writing Professionally
The Email (Part 2: Tone & Register)

- Formal vs. Informal - **Know Your Audience**

Informal to teammate	Rewrite for your manager
"Hey, the server's freaking out again. Can you check it when you get a sec? Thx!"	**Subject**: Intermittent Server Instability Reported. **Body**: Hi [Manager's Name], We're experiencing intermittent stability issues with [Server Name]. I'm investigating and will provide an update by 3 PM. Best, [Your Name].

Group Activity - The Bad Email Clinic



The Sick Email:
text

To: sarah.davis@company.com
Subject: hey

Hi Sarah,

Hope you're having a good week! So, yeah, I was walking by the big conference room yesterday and today, and I noticed some people were having trouble with the internet. Their laptops kept disconnecting or something. I'm not totally sure what's wrong, but it seems like maybe the Wi-Fi is not great in there? It might be the router? Anyway, just wanted to let you know. Maybe we can do something about it when you have time.

Cheers,
Alex

Diagnose, Prescribe, and Heal

Step 1: Diagnose (Find 3 problems)
Discuss: What's wrong with this email?
(Hint: Remember A-B-C!)

Problem with Subject: _____

Problem with Body (BLUF): _____

Problem with Call to Action: _____

Step 2: Prescribe (Rewrite It!)
Use the A-B-C structure to write a new, professional version on your paper.

A (Subject): [Write a clear, actionable subject line]

B (Body/BLUF): [Get to the point in the first sentence]

C (Call to Action): [State what you need or recommend]



Prescription Pad

New Email:
To: sarah.davis@company.com
Subject: _____

Body: _____
_____
_____

From,
Alex

Diagnosis:

- **Subject:** "hey" is vague and unprofessional. Gives no information.
- **Body/BLUF:** No BLUF. It's rambling ("I was walking by..."). The core issue (unstable Wi-Fi for 2 days) is buried.
- **Call to Action:** None. It ends with "Maybe we can do something... when you have time." No clear request.

Example of a Healthy Rewrite (**A-B-C Structure**):

- ✓ **Subject:** Urgent: Unstable Wi-Fi in Main Conference Room - 2-Day Issue
- ✓ **Body:** This is to report persistent Wi-Fi instability in the Main Conference Room, affecting meetings since Monday. Multiple users have experienced frequent disconnections. I recommend we check the conference room router and access point. Please advise if I should proceed with diagnostics today.
- ✓ From, Alex

Group Work Time: Draft Your Email

Scenario:

TechCorp’s new payment feature is failing with Error 500. Your manager, Peter Kodjo, is in an executive meeting. The development team needs details.

➢ Draft a SHORT EMAIL to your Manager, Peter Kodjo.

Goal: Urgent, high-level update.

Remember: A-B-C Structure.
A: Actionable Subject (Include "Urgent" and context).
B: BLUF – Bottom Line Up Front (What, impact, what you're doing).
C: Clear Call to Action (What do you need from him?).



Subject: URGENT: Take-ups new payments failing – Error 500

Hi Peter,

Bottom Line Up Front: Take-ups new payments are down as of 9:15am GMT. Users get Error 500 at checkout. Revenue impact ongoing. I'm coordinating with Devs now to diagnose.

What's happening:
Dev team needs priority details from the logs + any recent changes to payment service. I've started an incident thread and am pulling error rates.

What I need from you:
1. Can you approve a hotfix window if Devs find the cause in the next 30 mins?
2. If asked in the exec meeting, should I say we're targeting a fix ETA of 1 hour or wait for Dev confirmation?

Will update you in 20 mins or sooner.

Thanks,
[Your Name]

URGENT: Take-ups new payments failing – Error 500

Hi Peter,

Take-ups new payments are down as of 9:15am GMT. Users get Error 500 at checkout. Revenue impact ongoing. I'm coordinating with Devs now to diagnose.
Dev team needs priority details from the logs + any recent changes to payment service. I've started an incident thread and am pulling error rates.

1. Can you approve a hotfix window if Devs find the cause in the next 30 mins?
2. If asked in the exec meeting, should I say we're targeting a fix ETA of 1 hour or wait for Dev confirmation?

Will update you in 20 mins or sooner.

Thanks,
[Your Name]

Shorter Version for Mobile

URGENT: Take-ups payments down – Error 500

Hi Peter,

Take-ups new payments failing with Error 500 since 9:15am GMT. Revenue impact ongoing. I’m with Devs now.

Need from you:
1. Approve hotfix window if we find root cause in 30 mins?
2. Share 1-hour fix ETA in exec meeting, or wait for Devs?

Will update in 20 mins.

[Your Name]

Review and Reflection

- What have you learned today?
- Share one thing you learned and how you will apply it





Homework



1. Vocabulary Log: Find an online article about a recent IT trend. Identify and write down 10 new technical terms with their definitions.

2. Writing: Write a professional email to a hypothetical team lead. Inform them of a recurring, minor bug in the reporting tool and suggest a time to discuss it.

Instruction: To be completed in your notebook before next class.
Note: This work is compulsory.
Students without completed homework at the start of class will receive a 2-mark deduction.

Some valuable resources:

1. Core Reference Books:

- "English for Information Technology" (Pearson Longman Vocational English Series) by Maja Olejniczak.
- "The Tech Whisperer" by Jaspreet Bindra.

2. Online Readings & Practical Guides:

- GitHub's "Awesome README" List:

Link: https://github.com/matiassingers/awesome-readme

- Microsoft Writing Style Guide:

Link: https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/style-guide/welcome/

3. For Vocabulary Building:

"Dictionary of Computer and Internet Terms" (Barron's Business Dictionaries)

Preview of Session 2



We'll practice:

- ❖ listening to technical talks,
- ❖ role-play user support calls, and
- ❖ learn how to structure a project presentation.

Get ready to speak!



COLLEGE DE PARIS SUPERIEUR

Thank you!



dtchogoue@collegedeparissuperieur.fr